Start Here - Monthly Budget Spreadsheet

Everything in this kit, and how to open it. Two minutes, then your budget is running.

WHAT YOU HAVE

1. Monthly-Budget-Spreadsheet.xlsx - the budget spreadsheet. 16 tabs: a Start Here guide, 12 monthly budget pages, an expense log, a debt payoff tracker, and a Year at a Glance page that fills itself from the month pages.
2. Monthly-Budget-Filled-Example.xlsx - the same spreadsheet with January filled in full and February started, so you can see the totals work before you type anything.
3. This page - how to open the spreadsheet, whichever app you use.
4. PERSONAL_USE_LICENSE.txt - the personal-use licence.

FIRST, MAKE YOUR OWN COPY

Google Sheets: use the ready-made copy link in the box below, then click "Make a copy". The copy lands in your own Google Drive, fully editable.

Opened this file from Drive instead? File > Make a copy does the same thing.

Excel: the .xlsx file in your download is already yours. If Excel says "Protected View", click "Enable Editing" at the top and start typing.

SELLER'S READY-MADE COPY LINK

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1M6n9iCP5guiQ8J99q2LRDL_UxFS1oU6k/copy

Open the link above and click "Make a copy" - it saves an editable copy to your own Google Drive.

START WITH THREE PAGES (THE REST IS THERE WHEN YOU NEED IT)

1. THIS MONTH'S PAGE - open the tab for the current month (Jan, Feb, ...). Type your income, your bills and what you spend in the light-blue cells. The grey totals - income, out, saved, left over - add themselves up.
2. EXPENSE LOG - one line per spend: date, what it was, category, amount. The log totals itself by month and by category at the bottom of the page.
3. YEAR AT A GLANCE - do not type here at all. It fills itself from the twelve month pages, so you can watch the year build up.

THE OTHER PAGE

DEBT PAYOFF - list each debt once: what you owed at the start, what you have paid so far, the APR and your monthly payment. The sheet works out what is left and an estimated number of months to clear it. Update "Paid so far" as you go.

WHICH CELLS DO I TYPE IN?

Light-blue cells only. Everything grey or white is a total or a label - the sheet does that maths for you. On the month pages you type amounts; on the Expense Log you type date, item, category and amount (the Month column fills itself); on Debt Payoff you type the first five columns.

A NEW YEAR

The month tabs are one year of months. When a new year starts, make a fresh copy of the blank file and start again - last year's copy stays as your record.

THREE QUESTIONS EVERYONE ASKS

Q: The Google Sheet says "view-only" - how do I get my own editable copy?

A: That view-only sheet is the shared master. Use the copy link in the box on page 1: click it, press "Make a copy", and the sheet lands in your own Google Drive, fully editable. Prefer Excel? Download the .xlsx file instead and open it - that file is already yours, no copy step.

Q: How do I make it mine once I have the copy?

A: Open this month's tab and type in the light-blue cells: your income, each bill (with its due day), what you spend in each category, and what you save. Planned is what you intend, Actual is what really happened - the summary at the bottom shows both, plus what is left over. There is nothing else to set up.

Q: Can I use it on my phone?

A: Yes. Your copy opens in the free Google Sheets app, and the .xlsx opens in the free Excel app - same cells, same formulas, on phone, tablet or computer. You need a free Google account for the Sheets copy; no subscription and no other software for either route.

Stuck? Message us through Etsy and tell us which step you reached - we will get you unstuck.

Personal use only. Settled Days